

IAA lobbying turns to Council

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【要点】

- ・外国の自動車メーカーがEU内での製造を義務付けるIAA（産業加速化法）に対して、欧州議会が厳格な基準を支持しているため、これらのメーカーは加盟国に働きかけを強化している。
- ・欧州議会の報告書ではEU加盟国内での組立のみを公的補助金の対象とする「Made in Europe」基準を求めており、ホンダやトヨタなどの非欧州メーカーは対象外となる可能性が高い。
- ・英国などの地理的に近い国や欧州自由貿易連合の加盟国は基準に追加される可能性があり、英国の自動車業界は競争力維持のためこの変更を期待している。
- ・非欧州メーカーはIAAの改正により戦略的パートナー企業も関与できるようにすることを求めており、厳格な保護主義的アプローチがネットゼロ化への進展を阻害すると主張している。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Foreign automakers unable to qua

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— Foreign automakers unable to qualify for excluded for the EU's Made in Europe label are looking to member states to water down the IAA.

— Chinese and U.S. manufacturers could grab more than a quarter of Europe's electric heavy-truck market by 2030 unless European truckmakers speed up their switch to electric.

— Europe plans to requisition civilian transport in a crisis, but industry and governments warn a shortage of workers to operate it could become a wartime bottleneck.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

FOREIGN AUTOMAKERS HOPE FOR COUNCIL HELP ON IAA: The European Parliament is doubling down on the European Commission's proposal for the Industrial Accelerator Act, reaffirming that only vehicles

assembled in the 27 member states should be eligible for public subsidies. It's a blow to foreign automakers which have been lobbying the EU to be included as Made in Europe. That's prompting them to shift their attention to EU capitals.

Catch up: The IAA sets rules for local content requirements for critical sectors, like EVs, which receive government subsidies. The Commission's automotive package also sets binding electrification targets for member states, and they would have to be assembled in the EU under the executive's proposal.

Parliament's demands: The three lead MEPs want a stricter Made in EU criteria, according to their 94-page draft report, obtained by POLITICO. They acknowledge, however, that geographically close countries like the U.K. or members of the European Free Trade Association will likely be added. That would be a relief to U.K. manufacturers. The IAA as currently written results "in UK-assembled vehicles being uncompetitive, threatening the viability of the UK automotive industry and severely damaging the EU industry," a spokesperson for U.K. car lobby SMMT told POLITICO.

Up to Council: Non-European automakers like Honda, Toyota or Hyundai, however, would be left out in the cold under this definition. With Parliament's position set, foreign carmakers are lobbying member states. "It's now up to the Council — and remaining pro-free trade voices in Parliament — to amend the IAA to ensure that Europe's strategic partners can still play a role," a senior official at a non-European automaker told your anchor. "The strict protectionist approach proposed by the rapporteurs risks slamming the brakes on the race to net zero mobility."

Suppliers rejoice: As scooped in Wednesday's newsletter, the Parliament report wants to increase the required share of EU-made components in vehicles from the proposed 70% to 75%. "Policymakers are increasingly acknowledging the importance of EU suppliers and the need to keep a strong supplier manufacturing base in Europe," Benjamin Krieger, the secretary-general of supplier lobby CLEPA, told your anchor in a statement. "We strongly encourage the Council to move swiftly in the same direction, building on initiatives put forward by various member states."

Increased steel requirements: Under the Commission's auto package, automakers can meet lower emission targets if they invest in green steel. The IAA is meant to define what counts as low-carbon steel. But the three co-leads in Parliament made clear they want green steel to play a bigger role in the automotive sector. The Commission's IAA proposal mandates at least 25% of a vehicle's steel be low-carbon. The Parliament draft would progressively increase that amount to 35% in 2032 and 50% in 2036.

More raw materials: The Parliament draft also adds a new requirement for batteries for electric vehicles with an amendment stipulating that at least 20% of a batteries' critical raw materials must be mined, processed or recycled within the EU. China controls the vast majority of the battery supply chain.

TRUCKS

CHINESE E-TRUCK PRESSURE BUILDS: Chinese and U.S. manufacturers could grab more than a quarter of Europe's electric heavy-truck market by 2030 unless European truckmakers speed up their switch to electric, according to new analysis from Transport & Environment. More than half a dozen Chinese manufacturers have been preparing European launches this year, including BYD, Windrose and SuperPanther.

Cheaper to run: Some Chinese electric trucks are expected to sell for as much as 30% less than European models, helped by China's larger market and cheaper battery supply chain. T&E estimates that could make a Chinese e-truck 12% cheaper to own and operate overall — saving a German hauler

as much as €43,000 over five years.

And they can compete: The green NGO says the newcomers are already broadly matching European trucks on the things operators care about most: range, charging time, how much they can carry and energy efficiency. That raises the prospect that price, rather than technology, becomes the deciding factor for trucking companies operating on already-thin margins.

Europe knows what's coming: Daimler Truck, Volvo, Iveco and Traton still dominate Europe's truck market, but manufacturers and industry groups have been increasingly vocal about the competitive threat. ACEA and E-Mobility Europe are pushing Brussels to do more to create demand for electric trucks, including lower road tolls, stronger incentives and measures encouraging big fleet operators to buy zero-emission vehicles.

The policy dilemma: At the same time, European manufacturers have been asking Brussels for more flexibility on the EU's truck CO2 targets, arguing that demand and charging infrastructure are not developing quickly enough. T&E says that would be the wrong response: easing the targets could slow European manufacturers' electric push just as Chinese and U.S. rivals are scaling up.

Car industry déjà vu: The NGO warns Europe risks repeating what happened with passenger cars, where Chinese manufacturers built up a strong position in electric vehicles while European companies moved more cautiously. Competition could ultimately mean cheaper trucks for haulers, but T&E's warning is that Europe's manufacturers have a shrinking window to make sure those trucks are still built by them.

AVIATION

UK AIR CHAOS DRAGS ON: Britain's air traffic control failure is still hitting passengers a day after the original glitch was fixed, with 291 flights canceled Wednesday after around 1,750 were axed Tuesday.

Why it's lingering: Airlines are scrambling to reposition aircraft and crews left stranded by Tuesday's air traffic control system shutdown, with Heathrow and Gatwick warning that disruption will take time to unwind. British Airways alone canceled 198 flights Wednesday, while Ryanair says the cost of the disruption will run into the millions.

Pressure on NATS: Chief executive Martin Rolfe has apologized and ruled out a cyber-attack, promising a full investigation. Transport Secretary Heidi Alexander has summoned him for talks and is demanding assurances that Britain's air traffic systems are "up to the job."

Déjà vu: The failure comes after another National Air Traffic Services glitch in 2025 and a major 2023 outage that affected more than 700,000 passengers. Ryanair has renewed calls for Rolfe to be fired, saying repeated failures show the government needs to intervene.

AIR ARABIA PULLS RUSSIA FLIGHTS: Air Arabia has canceled flights to Russia for October and December, according to Russian outlet Baza , with affected passengers set to receive refunds.

Communication gap: Tour operators and agents reportedly noticed October bookings disappearing before receiving any formal notice from the airline, while tickets were still being sold on Air Arabia's website for flights to Moscow, Yekaterinburg, Kazan, Ufa and Samara.

Security backdrop: The cancellations come days after Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned that Russian airspace was becoming "completely unsafe" as Kyiv steps up long-range drone operations. Ukraine has since formally warned ICAO about risks to civilian aviation — though there is no indication

Air Arabia's decision is connected.

RAIL

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT REACTIONS: The European Commission's push to move beyond lowest-price tendering got a broadly positive reception from transport groups Wednesday. Rail suppliers strongly backed European preference and quality criteria, while road haulers welcomed simplification but warned that Buy European rules must not leave operators carrying disproportionate risks.

ICYMI: Industry Commissioner Stéphane Séjourné presented the new Public Procurement Act Wednesday as a way to simplify tendering and give more weight to quality, social and strategic considerations.

Rail POV: Rail manufacturers' association UNIFE gave the proposal a warm welcome, saying Brussels had answered longstanding calls for a simpler and more strategic procurement regime. The rail lobby particularly backed the proposed European preference framework and minimum quality weighting, arguing that long-life rail projects should be awarded on the basis of best price-quality rather than lowest upfront cost.

Road transport: Haulers association IRU also welcomed the move away from lowest-price awards, alongside simpler procedures, less paperwork and digital tools that could make tenders easier for smaller operators to access. However, it struck a more cautious note on European preference, warning that when such requirements apply to transport services, operators should not be saddled with disproportionate risks or liabilities outside their control. IRU also wants tighter safeguards around contracts awarded directly to publicly controlled entities without competition.

What's next: Parliament and EU countries now have to agree on how far the new framework should go — with rail likely to be one of the sectors where the balance between price, quality and European preference is most consequential.

MILITARY MOBILITY

MILITARY MOBILITY'S WORKFORCE GAP: Europe has plans to requisition civilian trucks, trains, buses and ships in a crisis — but no clear plan for the workers needed to operate them. Industry groups and national governments now warn that existing labor shortages could become a serious bottleneck in wartime.

Martina has the full story here .

PIT STOPS

The Trump administration blasted Ford for its partnerships with Chinese automakers, calling them national security risks.

Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Trump says Iran war will end 'immediately' after midterms

The president accused Iran of escalating the conflict to hurt Republicans in November, as soaring energy prices threaten to deepen voters' economic concerns.

By Scott Waldman · Sept 09, 2026, 09:25 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Even Trump-friendly EU countries back Brussels' pact with Canada

The plan would see ties strengthened in areas such as technology, trade and critical raw materials.

By Gabriel Gavin, Gerardo Fortuna · Sept 09, 2026, 06:46 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Europe's military mobility plans have a workforce problem

Europe has plans to move troops and gear across the continent in a war — but industry groups and national capitals warn it ignores workers.

By Martina Sapio · Sept 09, 2026, 04:42 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU seeks to transform procurement into €600B driver of industry

A streamlined rulebook would set clearer guidelines for public authorities — giving a higher weighting for “quality” against cost.

By Aude van den Hove, Pieter Haeck · Sept 09, 2026, 02:42 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

New EU Arctic strategy to release Oct. 20

By Martina Sapio · Sept 09, 2026, 02:36 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: Lead MEPs want tougher Made in Europe rules, investment curbs in industry act

A draft report calls for stricter curbs than foreseen by the Commission, putting the EU Parliament at odds with member countries.

By Francesca Micheletti · Sept 09, 2026, 01:20 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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